

Superintendent Pay in Context

Andover, CT · Dr. Valerie Bruneau and her Connecticut peers · FY 2025–26

A personal report by Scott Sauyet · scott@sauyet.com · Not an official town document

*Data covers essentially every Connecticut public school district that operates only elementary grades (PK/K through 6 or 8) — 45 districts, minus Norwich as structurally unlike. Contracts were assembled from town and school-district websites, OCR of scanned PDFs, and direct §10-244c records requests to town clerks where public postings did not surface a current contract. Of the 44 working-set peer districts, contract data is in hand for **40 districts across 30 unique peer superintendent contracts**, plus four reference contracts (Amity Region 5, Northwestern Region 7, Chaplin/Region 11, and Union) included on the contracts subpage but not ranked. For the remaining 4 peer districts a thorough search of public sites and clerk outreach has not yet produced a current contract. All figures are “cash compensation” — the salary line plus any board-paid 403(b) annuity, longevity bonus, fixed transportation allowance, and other lump sums. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are excluded. Because Connecticut superintendent contracts vary widely in work effort — from 12-hour-per-week part-time positions to full-time K-12 regional superintendents — all dollar figures are normalized to a hypothetical 1.0-FTE-equivalent (260-day work year) for apples-to-apples comparison. Andover’s portion of Dr. Bruneau’s compensation is reported separately so readers can see both what Andover pays and what her market-rate compensation works out to.*

INTRODUCTION

Overview

Andover pays its superintendent among the very lowest per-FTE rates of any K-6/K-8-only elementary superintendent in the state. In the strict K-6/K-8 comparison — 2024-25 and 2025-26 contract vintages only, 24 peers — Andover is **23rd of 24**, at **\$166,667** against a peer median of \$193,157 (roughly 16% above Andover). The only peer below is Eastford, a 130-student district whose superintendent works 104 days per year (0.40 FTE), at a derived FY 2025-26 rate of \$158,695 — about 5% below Andover. The broader view (which also admits 2026-27 vintage-fallback entries) tells the same story: Andover 29th of 30, Eastford last. Every other current K-6/K-8 peer contract pays substantially more, and so do all the districts with more complex shared-administration arrangements. *A caveat: we are still attempting to collect current-vintage*

information on five additional peer districts. Those could conceivably add another data point at or below Andover's rate, but the general picture — Andover at the very bottom of the peer distribution — is unlikely to change materially.

Dr. Valerie Bruneau is Andover's Superintendent of Schools, and also Scotland's, under a separate Scotland contract. She works 0.6 FTE for Andover; her separate Scotland contract engages her at 0.4 FTE — each fraction stated explicitly in its own contract. Andover's contract pays her \$90,000 cash plus a \$10,000 mandatory 403(b) deferral for the 2025–26 school year, an Andover-paid total of **\$100,000**. Scaling that 0.6-FTE pay to a full-time rate produces the implied 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate of \$166,667 that the finding above rests on.

The comparison spans every other Connecticut superintendent contract we could locate for the 45 small towns identified as peers — towns of similar size, similar grade-level structure, and similar regional profile. Contracts came from public town-clerk pages, school-district CMS crawls, direct §10-244c records requests to town clerks, and a handful of user-supplied PDFs. Of 44 working-set peer towns (Norwich excluded as structurally unlike), we have contract data on 39. The report presents two different cuts of that data with different inclusion rules; **Andover sits at the very bottom of both.**

One pattern from the analysis is worth flagging up front: **within the K-6/K-8 cohort, FTE-equivalent pay is essentially uncorrelated with district enrollment** (Pearson $r \approx 0.17$ across 25 K-6/K-8 solo contracts). Small Connecticut elementary districts pay their superintendents in a fairly narrow band roughly independent of whether the district has 100 students or 1,200 — the going rate is a market price for the role, not a per-student rate. Andover's below-band position therefore isn't explained by the district being smaller than its peers.

METHODOLOGY

A note on methodology before the numbers

Two methodological choices shape every table that follows. Both deserve a line of explanation before the numbers appear.

FTE-equivalent, not raw salary. Andover is a small K-6 district whose part-time superintendent is also a part-time superintendent under a separate contract with Scotland. Other towns in the peer set are small enough that they share superintendents outright — Region 4 (Chester, Deep River, Essex/Centerbrook) has one K-12 superintendent across four boards; ER9 (Easton, Redding, Region 9) has one across three. Comparing Andover's \$100,000 Andover-paid amount to Region 4's per-town share isn't apples-to-apples because Andover is paying for a 0.6-FTE position while Region 4 districts are each paying for 25% of a different person's time. The FTE-equivalent normalization expresses each contract as "what would this superintendent earn if working a full 260-day work year at this district's pay rate." It is the metric that makes contracts comparable across different staffing arrangements.

By contract, not by district. When three boards sign one joint contract (McKinnon for ER9; White for Region 4), it is one observation, not three. The tables in this report dedupe by contract for joint cases (one row for McKinnon, listing Easton/Redding; one for White, listing Centerbrook/Chester/Deep River). Where the same person serves two districts under *separate* contracts, each contract is counted as its own observation. Bruneau’s Andover and Scotland contracts are the canonical example: she appears under Andover (2025-26 contract) and again under Scotland (2021-22, the latest Scotland contract located).

ANDOVER'S CONTRACT

Part 1 — Dr. Bruneau’s contract

The current Andover contract runs from July 1, 2023 through June 30, 2026. Section 2 explicitly defines the role as a 0.60 FTE position. Section 4 defines “annual base salary” as the sum of (a) a cash component paid biweekly and (b) a \$10,000 mandatory deferral into a 403(b) annuity. The three contract-year figures are:

Andover’s portion of Dr. Bruneau’s compensation

Contract year	Cash component	403(b) deferral	Andover-paid total
2023–24	\$80,000	\$10,000	\$90,000
2024–25	\$85,000	\$10,000	\$95,000
2025–26	\$90,000	\$10,000	\$100,000

Notes: Source: [Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026](https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf), Section 4 (BASE SALARY). The 403(b) amount is technically a “salary reduction agreement” — the Superintendent elects to defer \$10,000 of her base salary into a tax-sheltered annuity — but it is part of the total compensation the Board is obligated to provide, and the Board reports the full \$90K+\$10K total to the Connecticut State Teachers’ Retirement System.

What “\$166,667” includes. The comparison tables in Part 3 sum, for every contract, the same cash items: the salary cash component plus the board-paid or board-provided 403(b) annuity plus any longevity bonus plus any fixed transportation allowance. For Bruneau in 2025–26 that is \$90,000 cash + \$10,000 annuity = \$100,000 — both lines included, not just the salary cash. Divided by Andover’s 0.6 FTE gives the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate of \$166,667 used in every comparison below. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are *not* included for any contract — see the Methodology italic at the top of the report. The treatment is uniform: if a peer contract has its own annuity, it is added in the same way.

The 2026–2029 successor contract — referenced in the FY26/FY27 town budget approved February 11, 2026 — proposes a \$100,000 cash component for FY 2026–27, plus a \$15,000 annuity (up from \$10,000). Part 4 returns to that figure and shows where it would land in the current peer distribution.

PEER COHORT

Part 2 — The peer cohort

The original peer list contained 45 small Connecticut towns selected for similarity to Andover (small enrollment, small budget, K-6 or K-8 elementary structure, sometimes regional secondary). After excluding Norwich (which is structurally very different — much larger, much more urban), the working comparison set is 44 districts.

Of those 44, contract data is in hand for **32 unique superintendent contracts covering 40 peer districts. 30 of those contracts are ranked in the tables below**; four are treated as reference observations because the K-6/K-8 comparison isn't clean for them, and they appear on the [contracts subpage](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/>) but aren't ranked:

- **Amity Region 5** (Byars) — HS-only regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Bethany, Orange, and Woodbridge.
- **Northwestern Region 7** (LePage) — HS-only regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Barkhamsted, Colebrook, New Hartford, and Norfolk.
- **Chaplin / Region 11** (Skarzynski) — joint K-12 contract for Chaplin K-6 and Region 11 HS. Skarzynski also holds a separate 0.3-FTE Hampton contract, which makes the FTE denominator for the joint contract unreliable (treating it as 1.0 FTE would put his total at 1.3 FTE across all roles, which isn't physically plausible). Treating it as reference-only avoids a misleadingly low FTE-equivalent number in the ranking.
- **Union** (Jackopsic) — combined superintendent/principal position in a single ~45-student district (the smallest in Connecticut). The superintendent role is a \$10,701 addendum to the principal contract with no stated hours split, so its FTE-equivalent rate is a modeled construct rather than a contract-stated figure (see the note below).

Only **4 peer districts remain pending**: Woodbridge (K-6 supe being recruited), plus three very small EASTCONN-region districts where part-time superintendent arrangements are common but the supe's name and tenure are not always established with certainty (Ashford, North Franklin, Pomfret Center).

CGS § 10-244c (Public Act 17-2) directs town clerks to post superintendent contracts on the town website, but compliance is uneven. Requesting a copy from the town clerk — including via the state's Freedom of Information process — has turned out to be highly effective; almost every contract in the dataset that wasn't publicly posted was obtained through a polite records request to the town clerk.

The full list of pending districts appears in Sources at the end.

A note on the Chaplin/Region 11 reference contract. The Chaplin shared-office arrangement is documented in a [supporting research memo](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/research/chaplin-rd11/) (http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/research/chaplin-rd11/) sourced to the Central Office Committee (COC) Budget 25-27. The COC budget confirms the FY 2025-26 superintendent salary line is \$141,750 and that the Chaplin/RD 11 allocation for the Superintendent's Office is 40/60 — meaning Chaplin bears \$56,700 of that salary. Skarzynski also holds a separate 0.3-FTE Hampton contract. Under the reasonable assumption that no superintendent's contracted workload exceeds 1.0 FTE in total, Chaplin/RD 11 accounts for at most 0.7 FTE of Skarzynski's time, and Chaplin's 40% finance share of that maps to at most 0.28 FTE. Chaplin's implied K-6 FTE-equivalent rate is therefore **at least \$202,500** — comfortably in the K-6/K-8 band and above Andover's \$166,667. Not precise enough to rank cleanly against solo K-6 contracts, but not a case where Chaplin pays below Andover either. The supporting memo carries the full set of qualifications for a reader who wants to walk the underlying assumptions.

A note on the Union reference contract. Union — the smallest school district in Connecticut (~45 students, one schoolhouse) — was resolved by a records request to the town clerk, but with a twist: Union combines the superintendent and elementary-principal roles in one person under paired contracts. For 2025-26 the superintendent role is a \$10,701 addendum (exactly one-twelfth of the \$128,419 principal salary) with no stated hours split, so there is no contract-stated superintendent salary or FTE to rank. A [supporting research memo](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/research/union-combined-position/) (http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/research/union-combined-position/) reconstructs an FTE-equivalent rate by splitting the combined pay using the market ratio of superintendent to elementary-principal pay in Union's enrollment class (1.44, per the 2025-26 AASA salary study): roughly **\$217,000** FTE-equivalent on the memo's default accounting, which counts the 10% board TSA contribution but excludes the contract's cash-in-lieu-of-insurance stipend (matching the methodology's exclusion of peers' health benefits; counting the stipend raises the figure to about \$231,000), with an implied superintendent time share of about 5.5% — roughly 11–12 days a year. A peer-median benchmark and the ratio method agree on the time split within about a percentage point. The construct is consistent with the peer cohort's rates, but because it is a modeled figure rather than contract-stated dollars, Union is treated as reference-only rather than ranked.

COMPARISON

Part 3 — Two views of the comparison

The underlying data supports two views, each with a different inclusion rule. Both use the same vintage-fallback policy — **2025-26 data where we have it, 2024-25 if we don't, 2026-27 if that's all we have**. Older "stale" data is excluded from these tables but the underlying PDFs remain available in the [contracts](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) (http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) subpage and in the [spreadsheet](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx) (http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx) for inspection.

View 1 — All contracts we can find (current vintage)

The most inclusive ranked view. Includes every ranked contract whose data passes the vintage-fallback rule, regardless of grade-level scope. One contract — Byars Amity Region 5 — appears as an HS-only reference; two — Lisbon (Keating) and Sterling (Friend) — have their own contract-shape oddities flagged in the table notes.

Andover ranks **29th of 30** — second-lowest, just above Eastford. Mean: \$210,321. Median: \$198,850.

Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Dr. Jason McKinnon	2025–26	Easton, Redding	\$310,408
2	Brian J. White	2025–26	Centerbrook, Chester, Deep River	\$277,649
3	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
4	Sally A. Keating §	2026–27	Lisbon	\$251,210
5	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
6	Melony M. Brady-Shanley	2025–26	Falls Village, Kent, Lakeville, North Canaan, Sharon, West Cornwall	\$245,610
7	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
8	Dr. Jennifer Byars †	2025–26	Amity Region 5 (Bethany/Orange/Woodbridge)	\$243,762
9	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
10	Dr. Holly B. Hageman	2025–26	Marlborough	\$222,222
11	Theodore F. Friend §	2026–27	Sterling	\$219,860
12	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
13	Barbara Wilson	2025–26	Columbia	\$202,400
14	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
15	Dr. Candace Morell	2025–26	Storrs (Mansfield)	\$200,000
16	Brian Hendrickson	2025–26	Salem	\$197,699
17	Robert Gilbert	2025–26	Colebrook	\$195,620
18	Jeffrey F. Sousa	2025–26	New Hartford	\$193,250
19	Dr. Jack Zmary	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
20	Christopher Roche	2025–26	Woodstock	\$190,000
21	Dr. Julie Luby	2025–26	Winsted	\$189,100
22	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
23	Kai Byrd	2024–25	Bethany	\$184,642
24	Dr. Christopher Bitgood	2025–26	Canterbury	\$183,801
25	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307

Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
26	Andrew Skarzynski (Hampton)	2025–26	Hampton	\$179,167
27	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
28	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
29	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667
30	Dr. Donna P. Leake †	2025–26	Eastford	\$158,695

Notes: † Byars’s Amity Region 5 contract covers high-school-only (grades 7–12), a meaningfully different scope from the elementary-only superintendents that dominate this list — included as a reference observation representing 7-12 supervision paid by member towns through a regional district. § Lisbon and Sterling are entered under the vintage-fallback rule with 2026-27 contract data because no 2024-25 or 2025-26 data has been located for those districts. Their figures are the earliest year of a future-effective contract and may be re-papered upward by the time those years arrive. ‡ Eastford’s FY 2025-26 figure is *derived*, not directly cited in a document on hand. The June 19, 2026 annual amendment letter to Dr. Leake’s 2021 base contract states a 3.0% raise bringing FY 2026-27 salary to \$65,382.01 for 104 days; backing out that raise gives an FY 2025-26 salary of \$65,382.01 / 1.03 = \$63,478 (rounded), which at the same 104-day work year works out to an FTE-equivalent of \$158,695. The June 2025 amendment letter, which would confirm FY 2025-26 directly, is not on hand. Skarzynski also serves Hampton K-8 under a separate part-time contract (rank 26 above); his separate Chaplin+Region 11 joint K-12 contract is treated as a reference (see Part 2 introduction) rather than ranked, because the joint contract’s FTE denominator is entangled with the Hampton contract in a way we can’t cleanly resolve. The Steven LePage Region 7 (2023-2026) contract is excluded under the vintage-fallback rule because we have year-1 data only and the rule requires 2024-25 or newer — the PDF remains on the contracts subpage for reference.

View 2 — K-6 / K-8 only, current contracts only (strict)

The most apples-to-apples view: K-6/K-8 scope, contract data from 2024–25 or 2025-26 (no future-fallback). This eliminates uncertainty about whether older contracts have been renegotiated since and removes the joint-K-12 and HS-only outliers.

Andover ranks **23rd of 24** — second-lowest, just above Eastford. Mean: \$198,379. Median: \$193,157.
Andover is **–14% below the median**.

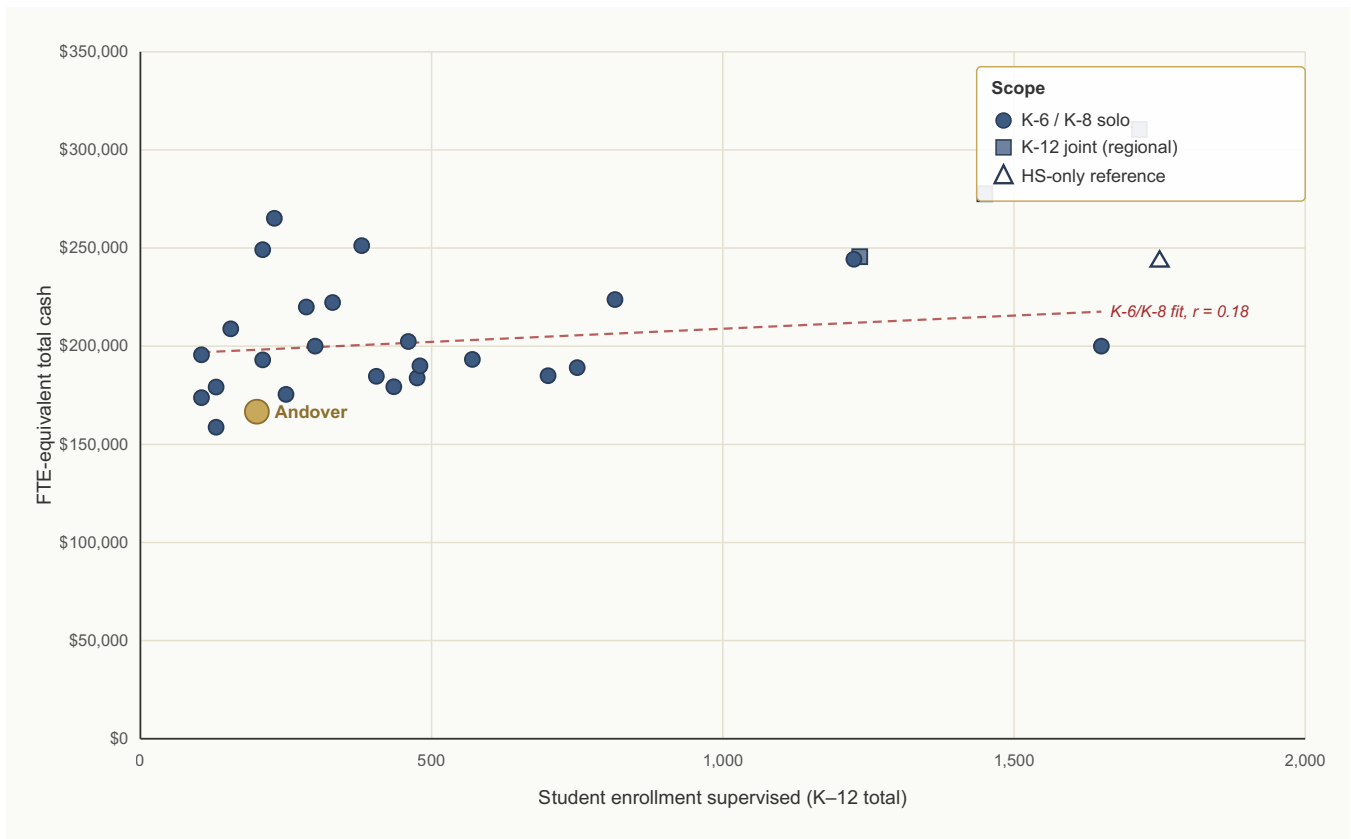
Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
2	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
3	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
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21	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
22	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
23	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667
24	Dr. Donna P. Leake ‡	2025–26	Eastford	\$158,695

Notes: Filter: --scope k-6,k-8 (the strict rule). **Only Eastford pays a lower per-FTE rate than Andover**, and by about \$8,000 (~5%). ‡ Eastford's FY 2025-26 figure is *derived*, not directly cited: the June 19, 2026 amendment letter states a 3.0% raise bringing FY 2026-27 salary to \$65,382.01 for 104 days; backing out that raise gives \$63,478 for FY 2025-26, which at the same 104-day work year is \$158,695 per FTE. The June 2025 amendment letter (which would confirm this figure directly) is not on hand. If the derivation is set aside, Andover remains rank 23 of 23 — last with no peer below. The next-lowest peer *above* Andover in either treatment is Norfolk at \$173,750, 4% above. Scotland is not in this table because the Scotland contract on file is stale (2021–22, Bruneau year-1 figure); a current Scotland contract has not been located, and there's no basis for assuming what rate it would land at — the two districts negotiate independently. The median is \$193,157 (15.9% above Andover); the mean is \$198,379 (19.0% above Andover).

ENROLLMENT

Pay vs district size

The two views above rank districts by FTE-equivalent pay only. This scatter overlays that pay figure against the total student enrollment the superintendent supervises, which is one of the plainer proxies for the job's scale.



Notes: Enrollment counts are the K-12 student totals under the superintendent's supervision for the 2024-25 school year (CT EdSight October-1 counts). For solo K-6/K-8 contracts, that's the district's elementary enrollment. For joint K-12 regional contracts (McKinnon ER9, White Region 4, Brady-Shanley Region 1), the count is the sum across all member districts' K-8 populations plus the regional HS. For the two HS-only reference contracts (LePage Region 7, Byars Amity Region 5), only the regional HS enrollment is shown. Andover's point is highlighted; among K-6/K-8 peers with similar enrollment, only Eastford pays a lower per-FTE rate. Enrollment values are cross-checked against published district budgets where available; where only approximate counts were available they are flagged in `enrollment.json` in the working repository.

Summary table

Question	Answer
What does Andover pay Dr. Bruneau for FY 2025–26?	\$90,000 cash + \$10,000 403(b) = \$100,000 total
What's the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate that implies?	\$166,667 (Andover engages her at 0.6 FTE — 60% of a full-time workload)
Where does that rank against peer Connecticut superintendents?	Second-lowest in both views: 23rd of 24 in the strict K-6/K-8 view, 29th of 30 in the broad view — only Eastford below
How far below the K-6/K-8 peer median is Andover?	\$26,490 (–14%) below the strict K-6/K-8 median of \$193,157; \$32,183 (–16%) below the broad-view median of \$198,850
Does any K-6/K-8 peer pay less than Andover?	Only Eastford — a 130-student district with a 104-day/year part-time supe, at a derived FY 2025-26 rate of \$158,695 (~5% below Andover). Derivation backs out the 3.0% raise stated in the June 19, 2026 amendment letter.
What is “cash compensation” in this report?	Base salary + board-contributed 403(b) + longevity bonuses + fixed transportation allowances
What's excluded?	Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, LTD, IRS-rate mileage, sick-day buyback

ANALYSIS

Key Observations

Andover's superintendent rate sits at the very bottom of the peer distribution across every cut of the data. The finding is not an artifact of one inclusion rule. In the strict view (K-6/K-8 only, 2024-25 or 2025-26 vintages — N=24) Andover is 23rd of 24, with only Eastford below. In the broad view (every ranked contract with current data, all scopes — N=30) Andover is 29th of 30, again with only Eastford below.

The strict K-6/K-8 view is the cleanest comparison. It eliminates two confounders — scope mismatch (K-12 regional supes earn more because their role is bigger) and stale data (older contracts almost certainly have step-ups not visible from the dollar figures we have). In that view, Andover is rank 23 of 24 — second-lowest, with Eastford (≠ derived FY 2025-26 figure) \$8,000 (~5%) below at \$158,695. The next-lowest peer *above* Andover is Norfolk at \$173,750, 4% above; the median is \$193,157, roughly 16% above.

Eastford's FY 2025-26 rate is derived, not directly cited. The June 19, 2026 amendment letter to Dr. Leake's contract states a 3.0% raise bringing FY 2026-27 salary to \$65,382.01 for 104 days. Backing out that raise gives \$63,478 for FY 2025-26 — \$158,695 per FTE at the same 104-day work year. The June 2025 amendment letter (which would confirm the figure directly) is not on hand; obtaining it would replace the derivation with a source-primary citation. If the derivation is set aside entirely, Eastford falls out of the strict view and Andover returns to 23 of 23 last — but the broader picture, that Eastford and Andover sit together at the very bottom of the K-6/K-8 distribution, is unaffected.

Stale and reference-only contracts don't appear in the ranking tables. The underlying older PDFs (Stevens West Willington 2023–24, Bruneau Scotland 2021–22, LePage Region 7 2023–24) and the four reference contracts (Amity Region 5, Region 7, Skarzynski Chaplin+Region 11, Jackopsic Union) remain on the [contracts subpage](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/>) and in the [downloadable spreadsheet](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx>) for inspection.

Enrollment doesn't explain the gap. Within the K-6/K-8 cohort, pay and enrollment are essentially uncorrelated (Pearson $r \approx 0.17$, $r^2 \approx 0.03$ — roughly 3% of the pay variance is “explained” by district size). Small CT elementary districts pay their superintendents in a fairly narrow band of \$175K–\$220K per FTE regardless of whether they have 100 students or 1,200, which the scatter plot in “Pay vs district size” above makes visible. Andover and Eastford both sit below that band. The apparent upward trend in the full-cohort scatter comes from the K-12 regional joint contracts (McKinnon ER9, White Region 4, Brady-Shanley Region 1) at the top-right, not from the K-6/K-8 cohort where Andover competes.

Only 4 peer districts remain pending. Records requests to town clerks under CGS §10-244c have resolved essentially every contract that could be resolved that way. The remaining four — Ashford, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Woodbridge — are the smallest of the EASTCONN-area districts plus Woodbridge, which is between supes. The missing rates could land above or below Andover's; whether they do is genuinely unknown.

CAVEATS

What this report does not show

- **Total compensation** including health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage. These items vary widely across districts and a fair comparison would require valuing each district's specific health plan; the cash-only comparison sidesteps that. This matters because superintendents negotiate their own preference balance between cash and benefits, and some low-cash contracts likely reflect a supe-side preference for a benefits-heavy package rather than a below-market total. A cash-only ranking cannot distinguish between the two.
- **Years of experience or tenure.** A first-year superintendent at \$200,000 is a different observation from a 20-year veteran at \$200,000. This report treats every contract uniformly regardless of the superintendent's experience.

- **Cost of living adjustments.** Fairfield County districts (Easton, Redding) have higher local costs than the eastern Connecticut towns that dominate the lower end of this distribution. The FTE-equivalent figures are nominal, not cost-of-living-adjusted.
- **Per-pupil or per-budget normalization.** A larger district legitimately needs a more senior superintendent, and some peers manage two or three times Andover's enrollment. This report normalizes by FTE, not by enrollment or budget size.
- **The missing peers.** The 4 districts where clerk outreach has not yet produced a current contract may have rates above or below the current cohort.
- **A causal claim about appropriateness.** This report describes where Andover sits in the peer distribution. It does not argue that being below median is good or bad, or that any particular pay rate is the "right" one. That is a judgment for residents.

DOCUMENTATION

Sources

Bulk downloads

- **All contracts as a zipped archive** (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.zip>) — every PDF referenced below, organized by district slug, with a manifest CSV.
- **Contracts subpage** (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/>) — sortable table linking directly to each contract PDF; stale and future-dated entries included with flags for inspection.

(The component-level spreadsheet that complements these sources is in the [Other Formats](#) section below.)

Andover-specific documents

- **Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026** — andoverelementaryct.org/.../2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (scanned PDF, OCR'd)
- **Andover FY26/FY27 Town Budget** — approved at the February 11, 2026 Town Meeting; provides FY27 proposed figures

Pending — contract not located in public search (4)

Four peer districts remain pending. Woodbridge is in transition (K-6 supe being recruited); the other three are very small EASTCONN-region districts where part-time supe arrangements are common and the supe's name and tenure aren't always established with certainty: Ashford, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center.

All 30 peer-district contracts in the analysis plus the four reference contracts (Amity Region 5, Northwestern Region 7, Chaplin/Region 11, Union) are listed with links on the [Contracts subpage](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/>) and included in the [downloadable ZIP](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.zip) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.zip>) and [spreadsheet](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx>).

Excluded

Norwich (too dissimilar in size and structure to be a useful peer).

Statutory basis

- CT Public Act 17-2 § 157 / CGS § 10-244c (requirement to post superintendent contracts on town websites)

Methodology and tooling

Contracts were collected by scanning town and school-district websites, running OCR on scanned PDFs, and extracting the relevant sections of each contract into a common structured format capturing cash components (base salary, board-paid 403(b), longevity, fixed transportation allowance, professional dues, other lump sums), work-year FTE fraction, contract term, and joint-signatories where applicable. Where public postings did not surface a current contract, the relevant town clerk was emailed a §10-244c records request; nearly every remaining contract in the dataset was obtained that way. The [compensation.json](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) data file linked from the [contracts subpage](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts/>) and the [spreadsheet](http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/aes/superintendent-pay/contracts.xlsx>) is the authoritative structured form of what was extracted from each contract PDF.

DOWNLOAD

Other Formats

This report is available in four formats, all located alongside this page:



HTML

Interactive version with formatted tables; best for on-screen reading and sharing.



Markdown

Plain-text version; readable in any editor, ideal for copying into other documents.



PDF

Print-ready version with all tables, footnotes, and source citations.



Spreadsheet (XLSX)

Every contract's cash components (base, annuity, longevity, transport, dues, other) on a By-district sheet and a deduped By-contract sheet. Hyperlinks to each PDF.

Compiled June 29, 2026 · Data from public CT town and school district websites, OCR'd scanned PDFs, and contracts supplied directly by town clerks in response to §10-244c records requests.

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